

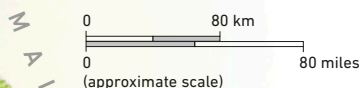


Young Jola drummers
The Jola people of southern Senegal play traditional drums called bougarabou at local ceremonies and celebrations.



Pink lake

Lake Retba, near Dakar, gets its pink color from algae that thrive on the high salt levels in its water. Salt crystals pile up on its shores.



- 75,955 sq miles (196,722 sq km)
- 15.7 million
- Dakar
- Wolof, Pulaar, other languages (+6)

Senegal has **grassy savannas** in its arid north and **lush rain forests** in the south. Mainland Africa's westernmost point is near the capital, Dakar. **Music, dance,** and **wrestling** reflect its **rich heritage**.



Abyssinian rollers

Forests and savannas are home to roller birds. They take their name from the thrilling midair rolls performed by males to attract females.

Wrestling

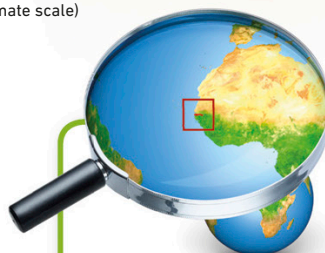
Just like in Senegal, in the Gambia, traditional wrestling is a huge sport as well as a cultural event.

The Gambia



Stone Circles of Senegambia

Stone circles dating back to the 3rd century BCE are spread across the Gambia River region.



- 4,363 sq miles (11,300 sq km)
- 2.2 million
- Banjul
- Mandinka, other languages (+5)

A **long, narrow** country that follows the **Gambia River**, the Gambia is enclosed by Senegal. The **riverbanks** are home to hundreds of different **bird species** and it has **beautiful beaches** along its tiny **Atlantic coast**.

